Signed by
Transition RAC
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Contributor Onboarding and Offboarding

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1. Purpose

This document defines how individuals join and exit the DAO as active contributors — covering Working Group members, contracted specialists, and Stewards.

Clear onboarding and offboarding procedures:

- Reduce ramp-up time for new contributors
- Protect continuity of work when contributors leave
- Ensure access controls are maintained
- Create a consistent experience across all Working Groups

This document covers the contributor lifecycle from first engagement to formal exit. Compensation terms are defined in the **Contributor Compensation Policy**. Role elections are defined in the **Elections & Role Governance Policy**.

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2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- **Working Group Stewards** — elected leads
- **Working Group Contributors** — individuals engaged by a Working Group to deliver defined work
- **Contracted Specialists** — external individuals or entities on short-term engagements

It applies across all Working Groups. Individual Working Groups may define supplementary onboarding steps within their charters, provided they meet the minimum standards in this document.

It does not apply to Governance Participants exercising ordinary governance rights.

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3. Onboarding

3.1 Pre-Engagement Checklist

Before a contributor begins work, the engaging Working Group Steward must confirm:

- ☐ Engagement terms documented (role, scope, compensation, start date) per **Contributor Compensation Policy**
- ☐ Conflict of interest disclosure submitted per **Contributor Compensation Policy §10** and **Conflict of Interest Policy**
- ☐ Contributor has read and acknowledged the **Code of Conduct**

☐ Access grants identified (see §3.4)
☐ Contributor added to the Working Group contributor registry

For Stewards, the above applies from the date their election result is confirmed.

3.2 Orientation

Each new contributor must be given an orientation covering:

- **DAO overview** — purpose, structure, and core principles (Charter summary)
- **Governance basics** — how proposals, voting, and the RAC work; where to find governance documents
- **Working Group context** — the Working Group's current mandate, priorities, active workstreams, and key contacts
- **Tools and channels** — the communication platforms, project management tools, and repositories the Working Group uses
- **Reporting expectations** — the cadence and format of monthly progress reports and quarterly retrospectives required of the contributor's role under the Working Group Framework §8
- **Security practices** — basic operational security expectations, especially for contributors with access to DAO systems or credentials

Orientation may be delivered asynchronously through written materials, a recorded walkthrough, or a synchronous session with a Steward or buddy. The Working Group Steward is responsible for ensuring orientation is completed within **7 days** of the contributor's start date.

3.3 Buddy Assignment (Recommended)

For new Stewards and contributors in longer-term engagements, Working Groups are encouraged to assign an experienced community member or existing contributor as a buddy for the first 30 days. The buddy's role is informal — to answer questions, make introductions, and help the new contributor find their footing.

3.4 Access Provisioning

Access to DAO tools, repositories, channels, and systems must be:

- **Scoped** — limited to what is needed for the contributor's defined role
- **Documented** — recorded in the Working Group's access log at the time of provisioning
- **Approved** — granted by a Working Group Steward; elevated access (e.g., treasury tools, credential stores) requires explicit sign-off

Access levels and the tools used by each Working Group are maintained in the Working Group's contributor registry.

3.5 Contributor Registry Entry

Upon onboarding, the Working Group Steward adds the contributor to the Working Group's public contributor registry with:

- Name or pseudonym
- Role and scope
- Start date
- Compensation type (not amount, unless the contributor consents to public disclosure of amount)
- Access level granted

The contributor registry is a public document maintained per **Contributor Compensation Policy §10**.

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4. During Engagement

4.1 Ongoing Expectations

Active contributors are expected to:

- Deliver work within agreed scope and timelines
- Communicate proactively about delays, blockers, or scope changes
- Attend relevant Working Group meetings or async equivalents
- Comply with the **Code of Conduct** at all times

4.2 Performance Issues

Where a contributor is not meeting expectations:

1. The Steward raises the issue directly with the contributor in private first
2. If unresolved, a formal written notice is issued with a defined improvement period
3. If still unresolved, the engagement may be terminated per §5

For Stewards, performance concerns are escalated to the RAC per **Elections & Role Governance Policy §10**.

4.3 Role or Scope Changes

Any material change to a contributor's role, scope, or compensation requires:

- Updated engagement terms documented in writing
- Contributor registry updated
- Access grants reviewed and adjusted if needed

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5. Offboarding

5.1 Triggers

Offboarding is initiated when:

- A contributor voluntarily resigns or concludes a fixed-term engagement
- A Steward's term ends (including non-renewal)
- A contributor's engagement is terminated by the Working Group
- A contributor is removed for misconduct per **Code of Conduct** enforcement
- A Working Group is dissolved

5.2 Notice Period

- For voluntary departures: a minimum **14-day** notice period is expected for contributors in ongoing retainer engagements, to allow for handover
- For fixed-term or milestone engagements: offboarding is triggered automatically at the defined end date
- For terminations for cause: offboarding may be immediate, with access revoked on the same day

Notice periods may be adjusted by mutual agreement between the contributor and Steward.

5.3 Offboarding Checklist

The Working Group Steward must complete the following for every departing contributor:

Knowledge Transfer - [ ] Departing contributor has documented the status of all active workstreams - [ ] In-progress deliverables handed over to a named successor or placed in a shared repository - [ ] Key contacts, context, and decisions documented and shared with the Working Group

Access Revocation - [ ] All system access, tool permissions, and channel memberships revoked - [ ] Any shared credentials the contributor had access to rotated - [ ] Elevated access (treasury tools, credential stores) revoked on the day of departure confirmation

Financial Close-Out - [ ] Final invoice or payment claim submitted and processed - [ ] Any outstanding expense claims submitted within **30 days** of departure - [ ] No further payments due after offboarding is complete

Registry Update - [ ] Contributor registry updated with departure date - [ ] Access log updated to reflect revocations

Access revocation must be completed within **2 business days** of a contributor's departure date. For terminations for cause, revocation is immediate.

5.4 Exit Feedback

Departing contributors are invited (not required) to provide exit feedback to the Working Group Steward or the Governance & Legal Working Group covering:

- What worked well in the engagement
- What could be improved in processes or tooling
- Any governance or conduct concerns they wish to raise

Exit feedback is used to improve Working Group operations. Conduct concerns raised during exit are treated as reports under the **Code of Conduct §5**.

5.5 Alumni Status

Former contributors who have completed their engagement in good standing may be acknowledged in DAO public records as alumni. Alumni have no special governance rights but may be re-engaged as contributors in future terms.

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6. Steward-Specific Procedures

6.1 Incoming Stewards

In addition to the standard onboarding process, incoming Stewards must:

- Complete a formal handover with outgoing Stewards within **7 days** of term start
- Review all active Working Group commitments, ongoing engagements, and outstanding deliverables
- Confirm or renegotiate active contributor engagements within **14 days** of term start
- Publish a brief statement of priorities for the new term within **14 days**

6.2 Outgoing Stewards

In addition to the standard offboarding checklist, outgoing Stewards must:

- Publish an End-of-Term Retrospective to the governance forum before handover, covering:
  - Delivery against the Working Group's mandate during the term
  - Budget consumption and any carry-forward requests
  - Outstanding commitments and obligations
  - Lessons learned and recommendations for the incoming term

- Prepare a handover document covering:
  - All active contributor engagements and their status
  - Outstanding commitments and obligations
  - Budget status
  - Key relationships, context, and institutional knowledge
- Remain available for questions from incoming Stewards for **14 days** after handover

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7. Working Group Dissolution

When a Working Group is dissolved (per **Working Group Framework §4**):

- All active contributor engagements are terminated with the maximum notice period or payment in lieu
- Full offboarding checklist is completed for every contributor
- All documentation is archived in the DAO's public repository
- Access to all Working Group-specific systems and channels is revoked and the systems decommissioned or transferred
- Outstanding obligations are resolved or transferred to the RAC for close-out

The RAC is responsible for overseeing Working Group dissolution offboarding to ensure completeness.

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8. Responsibility Summary

Action	Responsible Party
Completing onboarding checklist	Working Group Steward
Delivering orientation	Working Group Steward
Maintaining contributor registry	Working Group Steward
Completing offboarding checklist	Working Group Steward
Access revocation oversight	Working Group Steward + RAC (for elevated access)
Steward handover oversight	RAC
Working Group dissolution offboarding	RAC

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9. Relationship to Other Policies

- **Contributor Compensation Policy** — Engagement terms, compensation, and expense reimbursement
- **Conflict of Interest Policy** — Disclosure obligations at onboarding
- **Code of Conduct** — Standards of conduct; acknowledgement required at onboarding; conduct concerns raised during exit

- **Elections & Role Governance Policy** — Steward election, removal, and vacancy procedures
- **Working Group Framework §4, §8** — Working Group dissolution procedures and reporting cadence

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10. Amendments

*Amendment procedures and classification requirements are defined in the **Governance Maintenance & Upgrade Framework**.*